





Das's sculptures traverse Hindu mythology, Buddhism, abstraction and portraiture

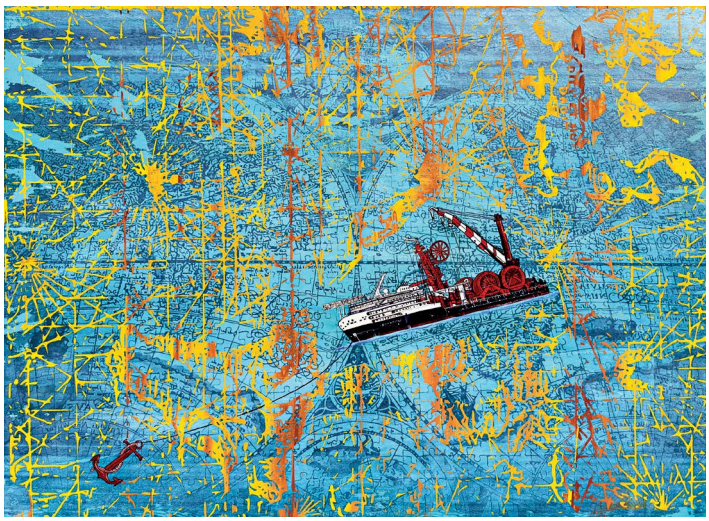
of Art, Delhi, for 25 years. Das is also deeply influenced by ancient Indian sculptures and architecture as well as their classical forms. "India is so rich, artistically and philosophically, that since a young age, I have tried to capture its essence and transmit it into modernity," he explains.

Some of his notable works include a many-handed form of Shakti, a rendition of Lord Krishna in the cross-hand posture, Lord Buddha in his various forms as well as the recurrent themes of *nayika* and Radha-Krishna. Further, his works, 'Budding Joy' and 'Rhythm of Life', are abstract renditions of nature. He has also produced portraits of famous statesmen and influential Indian thinkers, including Rabindranath Tagore. "His deep understanding of human anatomy, his commitment to archival research and adept use of symbolism give his works a distinctive quality that is rare to find. He is able to make the classical contemporary," adds Singh.

"I hope that those who look at my sculptures will see the essence of my country, its cultural heritage, sociological realities and geographic diversity," says Das. He also hopes that his work will have universal appeal, and stand on its own for generations to come. "In the near future, I may work with mixed media," hints the sculptor. ■

–Neha Kirpal

***The Journey Within – A Retrospective Show of Biman B. Das* will continue till Oct. 10 at Art Pilgrim, Triveni Kala Sangam, New Delhi**





VISUAL SYMPHONY
Clockwise from left, an untitled work by Nandhini Sreekumar; 'Fragments of Time' by Rutvi Bakharia; 'Around the World' by Himanshu Jamod

engagement in Satyanarayan Gavarra's works. Born into a family of tenant farmers, he was witness to various struggles that a tenant farmer undergoes at the mercy of the landlord, nature and economic decisions. "My works started as a portrayal of rural life and as I investigated further, I started to question the conditions of such exploitation which continues even today," he explains.

Gopa Roy expresses herself in rich organic paper-pulp material essaying structures and memories from her homeland, while Kalpana Vishwas innovates with foliage and natural forms. Govind Vishwas portrays attractive symbolist depictions of Baroda as well as maps of India on his delicate scrolls. Himanshu Jamod brings forward his personal narrative of growing up in a maritime family with boats navigating the swirling waters and maps with compasses representing their navigation. Further, Rutvi Bakharia builds a framed collage of preciously created small-format work, while Harsha Kancharla brings her white-on-white abstract works into focus.

"It is heartening to see that Baroda has moved way beyond the narrative school of paintings to include multiple modes of expression, from precise abstract works to expressionism and even hyper-realism," says Georgina Maddox, an independent critic, curator and herself an alumnus of the MSU Faculty of Fine Arts, who has co-curated this exhibition with Anu Bajaj. ■

–Neha Kirpal

***Baroda Buzz* will continue till Oct. 5 at Gallery Art Positive, Lado Sarai, New Delhi**